



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Brookstone Schools

School Website: <https://brookstoneschools.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit Report

Executive Summary - School: Barry County Christian School (BCCS) - URL audited: <https://bccsk12.com/>
- Overall classification: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL - Why: BCCS publicly affirms core hallmarks of classical Christian education—virtue formation; theology as “queen of the sciences”; the Trivium; Great Books; and the use of original sources. Evidence for pedagogy is strong at the grammar and rhetoric ends (memorization/singing; persuasive expression), but explicit signals for Socratic seminar/scholé and faculty formation are not yet visible on the site. Parent partnership is affirmed in principle, though fewer concrete parent-formation practices are documented online. These gaps keep the overall rating at SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL despite strong positives in the first three categories. Evidence examples: “Theology is the queen of the sciences” and an integrated “Biblical framework” for all subjects; Trivium (Grammar, Logic, Rhetoric); engaging Great Books and “ad fontes” original sources; early grades “memorizing, singing, and rhymes” and upper school “present ideas persuasively.”

Method note: Keyword analysis and scoring below use the Positive/Negative Keyword Indicators and definitions from Six Essential Elements of a Classical School and the classicality lexicon, applied across six categories (Religious/Metaphysical, Purpose & Goal, Curriculum, Pedagogy, Faculty, Parents/Community).

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations - Evident keywords/phrases from BCCS materials - “We Use a Biblical Framework to Understand Everything... all knowledge is interrelated and points back to Him. Theology is the queen of the sciences” (theology; divine order; integration) - “Education is the Cultivation of Virtue” (virtue, wisdom, moral formation) - “good, wholesome, beautiful” (beauty; transcendental language) - Alignment to Six Elements positive indicators - Transcendental moral realism: truth, goodness, beauty; virtue/wisdom.

- Grounded in theology: theology as “queen of the sciences”; biblical worldview integration.

- Liturgical/communal practices: no explicit references (e.g., chapel, liturgy) found. - Quantitative keyword readout - Positive hits: 7 (truth/goodness/beauty; virtue; wisdom; theology; Biblical framework; Creator/-Divine order; integration) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage (sub-elements evidenced): 67% (2 of 3: moral realism and theology strong; liturgical/communal not evidenced) - Category rating: CLASSICAL

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal - Evident keywords/phrases - “Education is the Cultivation of Virtue” (cultivation of virtue and wisdom) - “love of goodness,” “virtue of Wisdom” (formation over mere information) - “good, wholesome, beautiful” (reality of transcendentals) - Outcomes note (Good Soil): one “job” preparation outcome line appears in the comparative chart; not framed as the telos. - Alignment to Six Elements positive/negative indicators - Positive: formation; virtue/wisdom; true/good/beautiful. - Negative: workforce/job emphasis as telos (only incidental outcomes mention here). - Quantitative keyword readout - Positive hits: 6 (virtue; wisdom; formation; beauty; goodness; moral imagination) - Negative hits: 1 (job preparation mention in outcomes list) - Percent positive: 86% - Percent coverage: 100% (all three purpose criteria are signaled) - Category rating: CLASSICAL

Element 3: Curriculum - Evident keywords/phrases - “Trains student reasoning through the Trivium (Grammar, Logic, and Rhetoric)” (Trivium) - “engage great books and art... read original sources... Going ad

fontes... avoid textbooks for history and literature” (Great Books; primary sources; Great Conversation) - “history” study explicitly named (not “social studies”) - Alignment to Six Elements positive/negative indicators - Positive: liberal arts (Trivium); Great Books/primary sources; history emphasis. - “Wonder” language not explicit on the site pages crawled (though much aligns with depth/wisdom). - Quantitative keyword readout - Positive hits: 6 (Trivium; grammar; logic; rhetoric; Great Books; primary sources/ad fontes) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 75% (3 of 4—Trivium, history, Great Books strong; explicit “wonder” not evident here) - Category rating: CLASSICAL

Element 4: Pedagogy (Teaching Methods) - Evident keywords/phrases - “young children enjoy memorizing, singing, and rhymes” (memorization; chanting/singing) - “develop their ability to reason and discern truth” (logic/dialectic orientation) - “teach them how to present their ideas persuasively” (rhetoric; speeches/oratory) - Alignment to Six Elements positive/negative indicators - Positive: memory work via singing/chanting; logic/dialectic; rhetoric/persuasive expression. - Missing/less explicit: “Socratic”/seminar language; “restful learning/scholé” and “wonder” phrasing in pedagogy. - Quantitative keyword readout - Positive hits: 3 (memorization/singing; reason/logic; persuasive/rhetoric) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 40% (approximately 2 of 5 pedagogical emphases clearly evidenced on-site) - Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Element 5: Faculty - Evident keywords/phrases - Not enough direct, on-site statements found about faculty as “model teachers,” “mentors,” “living curriculum,” or a defined “portrait of a teacher.” (No clear hits in crawled pages.) - Alignment to Six Elements indicators - Positive indicators (teachers as models of virtue; mentorship/collegiality) are not visible on the pages we saw. - Quantitative keyword readout - Positive hits: 0 - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 0% - Percent coverage: 0% - Category rating: NOT CLASSICAL (insufficient public evidence)

Element 6: Parents and Community - Evident keywords/phrases - “Classical Christian Education goes beyond academic training... values the multidimensional training process of home, church and school... encourage families to remain active... strengthen the home, church, and school influences” (parent partnership; home–school–church synergy) - “Schedule a Visit”/“Let’s Chat” (openness; hospitality to families, though not explicit parent formation) - Alignment to Six Elements indicators - Positive: Partnership with families explicit; cultural/affective formation implied (home–church–school). - Missing/less explicit: Parent formation/book studies; “parents welcome anytime” language. - Quantitative keyword readout - Positive hits: 3 (parent partnership; community; shared mission) - Negative hits: 0 - Percent positive: 100% - Percent coverage: 33% (1 of 3 sub-areas clearly evidenced) - Category rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Aggregate Assessment - Category ratings: C1 CLASSICAL; C2 CLASSICAL; C3 CLASSICAL; C4 SOMEWHAT; C5 NOT; C6 SOMEWHAT - Overall: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Rationale: BCCS shows strong classical identity in its foundations, purpose, and curriculum—explicitly employing the Trivium, Great Books, ad fontes, and theological integration (theology as “queen of the sciences”), and grounding education in virtue and the transcendentals. Public materials currently provide fewer concrete details about Socratic/seminar practice, restful learning/scholé, faculty formation/portraits, and structured parent formation, keeping the aggregate just below a full CLASSICAL designation.

What Would Move the Needle (to CLASSICAL) - Pedagogy: Add explicit references to “Socratic seminar,” “Harkness,” “disputation,” and “scholé/restful learning,” and showcase upper-school orations/senior theses. - Faculty: Publish a “Portrait of a Teacher,” calling teachers mentors/models of virtue; describe ongoing classical faculty formation (e.g., Great Books seminars, classical pedagogy training). - Parents & Community: Highlight parent-formation practices (book clubs, classical education evenings), family liturgical rhythms, and open-visit policies. - Religious life: If applicable, describe chapel, hymnody, prayers, or liturgical calendar events integrated into school life.

References to Framework - Six Essential Elements of a Classical School (positive/negative keyword indicators used for scoring). - Classicality lexicon (category-aligned keyword set).

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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